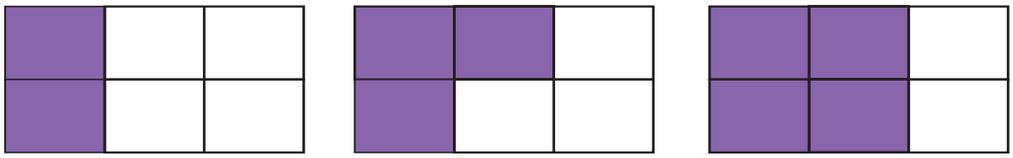
Like fractions and unlike fractions

Consider the following figures:



(i) (ii) (iii)

The fraction represented by (i) is $\frac{2}{6}$. The fraction represented by (ii) is $\frac{3}{6}$. The fraction represented by (iii) is $\frac{4}{6}$.

In $\frac{2}{6}$, $\frac{3}{6}$ and $\frac{4}{6}$, the denominators are the same. Such fractions are called as like fractions.

Like fractions

Fractions with same denominators are called **like fractions**.

Examples: $\frac{1}{5}$, $\frac{4}{5}$, $\frac{3}{5}$

Unlike fractions

Fractions with different denominators are called **unlike fractions**.

Examples: $\frac{1}{7}$, $\frac{2}{9}$, $\frac{9}{11}$

Converting unlike fractions into like fractions

To convert unlike fractions into like fractions, we change the denominators of the given fractions into a common denominator. This can be done by finding the common multiples of the denominator.

Example 6.6

Convert $\frac{5}{6}$ and $\frac{7}{9}$ into like fractions.

Solution

Find common multiples for the numbers 6 and 9

Multiples of 6 : 6,12,18,24,30,36,...

Multiples of 9 : 9,18,27,36,45,.....

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